Cutter



Category: **Hand Tools - Cutting & Shaping** Type: **Short SOP** Priority: **Medium** 3 labs

Covers these lab items: Cutters

What it is used for

To cut small wires, plastic parts, cable ties, or other materials using a suitable cutter. To make controlled cuts while protecting hands and nearby components.

Main parts

- Cutting jaws or blades
- Pivot joint
- Handles
- Insulated grips, if fitted
- Locking catch or spring, if fitted

Before you start

1. Identify the material and choose a cutter rated for that task.
2. Inspect the cutting edges, pivot, and handles for damage.
3. Disconnect electrical power before cutting wires.
4. Secure the workpiece and keep bystanders clear.
5. Wear eye protection when cut pieces may fly.

How to use

1. Open the cutter handles or release the lock if fitted.
2. Position the material fully within the appropriate cutting area.
3. Keep fingers away from the blades and the likely path of the cut piece.
4. Squeeze the handles steadily to complete the cut.
5. Avoid twisting the cutter or exceeding its rated capacity.
6. Inspect the cut and remove offcuts safely.
7. Close and store the cutter after use.

⚠ Safety

- Never cut live electrical wires.
- Do not use ordinary cutters on hardened metal or materials beyond their rating.
- Keep fingers clear of the cutting jaws and pinch points.
- Do not use cutters with cracked handles or damaged blades.

Care & storage

- Wipe the blades clean after use.
- Keep the pivot clean and lubricate as specified.
- Inspect cutting edges and handle insulation regularly.
- Store with the jaws closed and protected.

Common mistakes to avoid

- Cutting a live wire or an unknown circuit.
- Using the wrong cutter for the material.
- Placing fingers close to the cutting point.
- Twisting or overloading the tool.

Disclaimer: This SOP is prepared from general information available on the internet. For detailed instructions, refer to the manufacturer's original manual / file.

Prepared by - Subodh Kumar